

JON BAKER | HENRY MELLER

Meller's Second Coming at Boavista

A day after his 12 at the 17th, Meller's round and his gross score both rank 2nd-best in TEG history to date, with Jon Baker matching him on the harder metric via a far bumpier route.

Henry Meller and Jon Baker both carded -2 at Boavista. The score ties as the 2nd-best round in TEG history to date. Only one version of it came with decorations. Meller's gross 18-over is itself the 2nd-best gross round ever recorded in TEG, and it doubled as a personal best at Boavista, lowering his best there to 89 from a prior 91. Baker's -2 arrived in 26-over gross, unaccompanied by any milestone whatsoever.

Meller's round was a reversal of some violence. He had shot 8-over in the first

round, making the swing between rounds ten shots. The engine of it was a stretch of four shots to par from the 7th to the 9th. A double bogey at the 10th closed the window. Baker, historic score and all, suffered privately in the middle of his own round. From the 10th to the 14th he dropped ten shots across five holes. All doubles. Consistency of a sort.

Baker's round extended his TEG 12 Trophy lead to 13. Meller's lifted him off the bottom of the Wooden Spoon table. Stuart Neumann now occupies last place instead.

AT A GLANCE

ROUND OF THE DAY

Henry MELLER (-2)

TROPHY LEAD

Jon BAKER, 13 ahead

GREEN JACKET LEAD

David MULLIN, 5 ahead

ROUND NET VP

HM -2 | JB -2 | GW +1 | DM +3 | SN +3

ROUND GROSS

HM +18 | DM +21 | SN +21 | JB +26 | GW +31

AFTER R2 • TROPHY

JB -11 | DM +2 | GW +6 | HM +6 | SN +7

AFTER R2 • GREEN JACKET

DM +38 | SN +43 | JB +45 | HM +46 | GW +66

WOODEN SPOON

Neumann Inherits the Wooden Spoon Cellar

A tidy front nine unravelled at the 7th and 8th, swapping places with Henry Meller at the foot of the TEG 3 Wooden Spoon table, while David Mullin shrugged off a quintuple bogey at the 17th to push his Green Jacket lead out to 5.

Stuart Neumann had assembled something tidy through the middle of his round at Boavista. He held par or better across the 4th, 5th and 6th, the pars including one on the tricky par-3 6th, among the harder holes on the course. At the 7th the composure left him. A double bogey ended the streak and pushed him back over par for the

round. It was not a blip but an opening statement. A bogey followed at the par-5 8th, one of the easiest holes at Boavista. By the end of that hole Neumann had sunk to the bottom of the Wooden Spoon standings, overtaking Henry Meller, with one shot separating the two men.

It was a quiet kind of collapse. No blow-up hole, no single catastrophe to point at. Just three holes going the wrong way immediately after three that had gone right. Neumann's total for the round still matched his personal best at the course, set the previous year. On this occasion it earned him the TEG 2 Wooden Spoon.

GREGG WILLIAMS

A New Boavista Best, Somehow

Two stretches without a net par either side of a quadruple bogey at the 10th did not stop Gregg Williams finishing three shots better than any previous visit to the course.

Gregg Williams's second round at Boavista Golf & Spa Resort alternated between recovery and ruin, without ever settling on one. He opened strongly through holes 3 to 5, gaining four shots against par net, including a par salvaged on the par-5 3rd. Then the middle of the round dissolved. Across holes 8 to 11 he dropped 12 shots and did not

register a single net par. The centrepiece was a quadruple bogey 8 at the 10th, one of the hardest holes on the course. A third collapse arrived late. Holes 15 to 17 cost him eight more shots, headlined by a triple bogey at the 15th, the hardest hole at Boavista. And yet the wreckage counted as progress. Williams's gross score was a

personal best for Boavista, three shots inside his previous best of 105 and four better than his last visit, on his sixth trip to the course. Five previous attempts had been worse. That is the fact, and it should be sat with.

RECORDS & PERSONAL BESTS

Notable achievements: TEG 3, Round 2

TEG RECORDS

- Henry Meller's -2 is the 2nd-best round in TEG history to date
- Henry Meller's +18 (gross) is the 2nd-best Gross round in TEG history to date
- Jon Baker's -2 is the 2nd-best round in TEG history to date

RARE FEATS

- David Mullin runs up a 9 (+5) at the 17th — his career-worst on a par-4